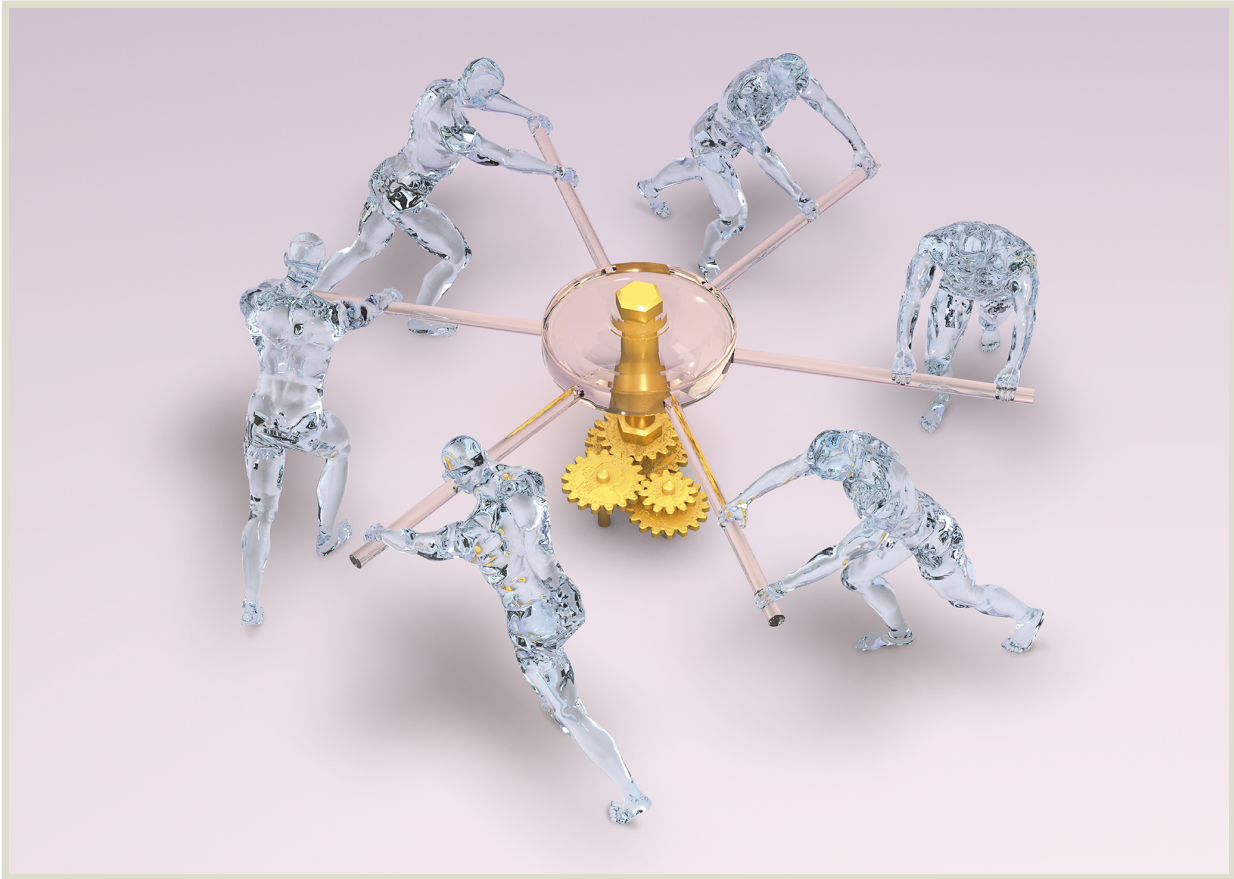




Working together

When individuals come together to form a cooperative movement they can use their strength of numbers to negotiate a better deal for their members.



BANKS AND CREDIT UNIONS

Credit unions are, in effect, small, private banks run by the people who bank with them. They help members come together to save and take out loans at fair rates. Most are open only to people who share an interest such as a profession or religion. Cooperative banks are larger and differ from commercial banks only in that they are owned by their customers and often have ethical investment policies.